

How can I reduce anxiety revolving around AI data centers increased strain on the US power grid/ cyberattacks and the general vulnerability of the US power grid itself

Posted by u/Alternative-Tree3170 • 0 points • 0 comments

I know this sounds crazy but recently anxiety has been increasing whenever I think about how vulnerable the power grid is, with how a number of coordinated attacks on power stations could trigger a black start, or the fact the ai data centers will increase the strain on the grid or the fact that advancements in ai can lead to increased cyber attacks etc? I'm an optimist at the end of the day but this thought has been dwelling lately

Comments

u/ThinkActRegenerate • 1 points • 2026-01-08 03:22 UTC

Use an EcoAnxiety Toolkit to help with this specific form of ecoanxiety - the Unscool of Disruptive Design has a free download. [\[https://online.unschools.co/courses/ecosanxiety\]](https://online.unschools.co/courses/ecosanxiety)(<https://online.unschools.co/courses/ecosanxiety>)

Also, consider whether a career shift into the renewable energy industry could be a way to "be the change" yourself: [\[https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/finding-a-job/renewable-energy-careers\]](https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/finding-a-job/renewable-energy-careers)(<https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/finding-a-job/renewable-energy-careers>)

And there are environmental policy people who have decided to switch job, and become hands on electricians, etc. expanding renewable energy. [\[https://www.fastcompany.com/90910359/ditch-your-desk-job-to-become-an-electrician\]](https://www.fastcompany.com/90910359/ditch-your-desk-job-to-become-an-electrician)(<https://www.fastcompany.com/90910359/ditch-your-desk-job-to-become-an-electrician>)

u/Pierson230 • 8 points • 2026-01-07 11:34 UTC

Understand that the things you do not know will always greatly outnumber the things you do know

Remind yourself that you are not always right

Between those two things alone, the odds of any scenario playing out exactly the way you conceive it are quite low.

After that, don't be so worried about tomorrow that you ruin today. If you had three months left of "fun", would you rather spend them having fun, or would you want to post on Reddit about how worried you are? You likely have a lot more than three months, but the concept applies.

So what do you do? You make some adjustments to your lifestyle to try to account for possible negative outcomes. Then you get back to living in today.

u/Automatic_Gas9019 • -3 points • 2026-01-07 09:45 UTC

Your anxiety is valid. However depending on where you live you can be somewhat productive to help yourself. We personally had in ground solar panels and a Powerwall installed. I recently got my report and it powered our house for 50 hours this year during grid outages. You can buy portable power stations with panels also. We have one that we had bought for emergency prior to having our panels installed.

u/FirmIndependent744 • -3 points • 2026-01-07 08:04 UTC

Your anxiety is well founded, imagine waking up one day and all the power is off...and the water, phones, internet, tv and radio down, traffic lights, financial markets and even buying bread and milk without cash impossible.

Day two or three and all the food is defrosting, people getting hungry, even wealthy people effectively destitute without a cash reserve, total communications blackout and growing civil unrest.

Ai is a potentially a good slave but a bad master: as we get more reliant on interconnected systems that we don't even fully understand I can see apocalyptic outcomes, either by hostile states or even Ai wars.

u/TrainsareFascinating • 9 points • 2026-01-07 07:48 UTC

This is something to talk to a therapist about, not an energy technologist.

Because anxiety is a strange thing - when we have unrealistic anxieties our anxieties go looking for things to focus on. Those things don't "cause" the anxiety, they are just something our anxiety is centered on for no real reason.

Barring some specific trauma that actually is due to an electric grid problem in the past, chances are that your anxiety will just latch on to some other issue if you get reassured about the reliability of the grid.

So the best thing would be to talk to your doctor or a therapist about how you feel.

Good luck, best wishes.

u/FirmIndependent744 • -2 points • 2026-01-07 08:05 UTC

Stupidity.

u/FirmIndependent744 • 0 points • 2026-01-08 02:30 UTC

Kick the ball , not the man.

Any grid power shortages addressed primarily by load shedding industrial users first, and many new Ai data centres have their own dedicated power generation systems.

Power distribution is a soft target, and as evidenced in Germany this week. Either by physical attack or cyber. Add Ai integration and the risks increase.

Can you reduce my our anxiety here by assuring me of zero chance of hostile states using cyber warfare against energy infrastructure? no, you don't know either.

u/Alternative-Tree3170 • 1 points • 2026-01-07 08:01 UTC

Let me rephrase! Not actual anxiety advice is what I'm looking for it's really not even anxiety despite the way I worded the post! Trying to find sources and developments within the energy grid/ securities and vulnerabilities of the power grid as a whole and developments the US has made within the sectors of renewable energy the security and safety of substations and advancements in power plants is somewhat difficult figured people on this subreddit would have firsthand/knowledgable experience that pertains to the listed problems I can see the power grid dealing with in the future! But yes I totally agree with you and appreciate the comment!

u/TheAstralGoth • 1 points • 2026-01-07 09:01 UTC

guessing this is in response to what just happened in germany. might wanna edit your post

u/Alternative-Tree3170 • 1 points • 2026-01-07 09:02 UTC

No idea what happened in Germany recently can you give me more info?

u/TheAstralGoth • 1 points • 2026-01-07 09:05 UTC

sure! there was just a terrorist attack on a power station in Berlin

<https://www.cbsnews.com/news/berlin-power-outage-vulkangruppe-left-wing-arson-attack-called-terrorism/>

u/Alternative-Tree3170 • 1 points • 2026-01-07 09:10 UTC

Oof thanks for the source that was a shocking read, stories like that are why I originally posted here (but not that story specifically) and am curious and optimistic that the various US corporations/departments/organizations are updating and safeguarding vulnerabilities or scenarios like this for our own power grid

u/Ok-Quality-9246 • 1 points • 2026-01-09 18:05 UTC

I feel like that incident in Berlin is actually a good example of how these risks can play out in reality. Localized disruption rather than systemic grid failure. The risks are real, but they're very different

from AI or data centers suddenly breaking the grid. What sort of stories triggered your concern? Were they US based?

u/Alternative-Tree3170 • 1 points • 2026-01-10 02:12 UTC

Most of them were rumors/hypotheticals which is why I was looking for sources before getting too worked up, but the fact that anyone in the us can get a gun without too many issues and go shoot up a substation raises concerns, the rumor that if 8/9 substations are all hit at the same time could cause a dark reset along with the fact that the political climate here is unstable, cyberattacks are improving with ai and technology all the time, as for real life scenarios nothing recent but I think of the 2003 Northeast blackout although technology has come a LONG way since then

anxiety lol

u/sorkinfan79 • 1 points • 2026-01-07 08:50 UTC

If anyone on here has inside knowledge about counterterrorism measures that are in place to protect certain parts of the electrical grid, I certainly hope that they don't post publicly about it :-)

u/Alternative-Tree3170 • 1 points • 2026-01-07 08:51 UTC

Ya got me there lmao

u/Oponionated • 1 points • 2026-01-07 07:46 UTC

I would read into how the world is tackling the problem.

DOE's Pathways to Liftoff reports are great. FERC Order 2222 and related rules and mandates. Concepts like Virtual Power Plants and None-Wires Alternatives.

Additionally would familiarize yourself with Distribution and Transmission Control Center operations.

This should give you hope. If we fail to address it then you'll at least know what safeguards, regulations, and mechanisms are in place to prevent DCs ever having priority over people at the tail end when, not if, this gets ugly.

u/Alternative-Tree3170 • 1 points • 2026-01-07 08:05 UTC

Yes! Specific reports and references like the ones you listed are exactly the kind of info I'm looking to familiarize myself with any more basic level pointers/ sources / etc you could point my way so I can start learning more about this area of the government (DOE power grid organizations/government infrastructure organizations or just more of what you mentioned would be awesome! Thanks!

u/Little_Category_8593 • 1 points • 2026-01-07 07:36 UTC

Actual attacks are very rare (outside of actual warzones like Ukraine). The grid is quite resilient and has a great number of very skilled professionals constantly working to keep it online and healthy. Data centers pose little reliability risk to the grid- the headlines you may be seeing this past year have to do with planned growth coming online years from now. There's a lot of money at stake, and it's a new trend, so it captures a lot of headlines.

But the biggest actual risk is likely things like ice storms and wildfires.

If you're able to weather a few days in that event, you're in good shape. And if not, it's easy to find resources for being reasonably prepared. I'm not talking "build a bunker," but rather meet your neighbors, have a supply of freshwater, etc. Check your county or town's emergency management office, or check with your fire department for trusted resources. And battery backups have fallen in price a lot recently- you can get a battery that will keep the food in your refrigerator safe for a day or two for a few hundred dollars at Costco- much less than the cost of replacing your food after a power outage.

u/AmpEater • 1 points • 2026-01-07 07:19 UTC

An ounce of prevention?

You have solar panels? What about a personal battery station to keep your phone / fridge running during an outage?

I feel good knowing I can operate my life pretty much indefinitely without the grid

The grid makes you complacent. Don't need it

u/FirmIndependent744 • 1 points • 2026-01-07 08:10 UTC

Solar inverters and domestic batteries (normally) need a mains supply, unless totally off grid, just like gas heating needs electric.

u/Alternative-Tree3170 • 1 points • 2026-01-07 07:24 UTC

Have basic prepper stuff solar generator and solar power bank for basic electricity devices stash of non perishable food decent supply of stored water for myself and family all the preps to last a few months, water purification tablets etc even with all this which makes me more prepared than the common individual in a grid down situation this thought/anxiety is still ruminating